

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 4
♥ K 9 7 2
♦ J 9 3
♣ 10 9 7 6

♠ A 6 2

♥ J 10 3

♦ 8 5 4

♣ A K 8 5



♠ Q J 9 8

♥ A 5

♦ Q 10 6 2

♣ Q 4 3

♠ K 7 5 3

♥ Q 8 6 4

♦ A K 7

♣ J 2

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1♦
Pass	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

You have 13 points so you will definitely open the bidding. You don't open with a 4-card Major and you don't open with a 2-card ♣ suit. So this is the one distribution where you open a 3-card ♦ suit. Partner responds 2♣ and

Be very careful! You are tempted to now bid 2♥ or 2♠. Don't give in to the temptation. That would be a **REVERSE** - bidding a second, higher-ranking suit at the 2-level. You should have at least 16 points to reverse. Besides, if you trust partner you don't need to bid either of those suits anyway. If he had a 4-card Major he probably would have shown it on his first bid. No, your next bid is clearly 2NT. Partner raises to 3NT and you pass.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♥2, East wins the ♥A and returns the ♥5. West takes the ♥K and plays the ♥7.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♥2, East wins the ♥A and returns the ♥5. West takes the ♥K and plays the ♥7.

Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 2 : Total = 8

You are glad the defense started with ♥s, that was a suit you would have had to play yourself. You need one more winner and your first thought may be that the ♠s are going to have to split 3-3. However, that happens only about 40% of the time so you keep looking. There is one more card that might be valuable, the ♣J. If East holds the ♣Q then you can make a trick out of the ♣J.

You are already in dummy with the ♥J so you lead a small ♣. If East plays low you will play the ♣J which will hold the trick and become your 9th winner. If East plays his ♣Q you will have the ♣J for your 9th winner later.

And if East doesn't have the ♣Q at all? then you **STILL** have the possibility of a 3-3 ♠ split.

As you see, this time the ♠s didn't split so you had to make the ♣J to succeed.

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -
 ♥ A K Q 10 3
 ♦ 9 6 4 2
 ♣ 10 6 3 2

♠ Q J 10 8 2

♥ 9 6 5

♦ Q 10

♣ Q 7 4



♠ K 7

♥ J 7 4

♦ A 7 5 3

♣ J 9 8 5

♠ A 9 6 5 4 3

♥ 8 2

♦ K J 8

♣ A K

West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	Pass	1 ♠
2 ♥	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

and a good suit and would have opened he bidding. But he didn't open, so he doesn't have the ♠ K.

You open 1 ♠. West overcalls 2 ♥ and partner bids 4 ♠.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads ♥ A, ♥ K, ♥ Q.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads ♥ A, ♥ K, ♥ Q.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

You have already lost the 2 ♥s and you will definitely lose the ♦. So you cannot lose a ♠ as well. When you have 11 cards in a suit missing the King, the recommended play is to play for the drop. But the recommended play shouldn't be used on this hand because you know that East has the ♠ K. How do you know this? Because West has turned up with 10 points in ♥s, (the A K Q and a fifth one). If he held the ♠ K as well he would have had 13 points

Ruff the ♥. Play the ♦ 8 to dummy's ♦ 10. If East takes the ♦ A win his return and enter dummy with the ♦ Q. When in dummy lead the ♠ Q and finesse East out of his ♠ K.

You have to listen to the bidding and draw conclusions from what is bid - and not bid. Because he passed originally you could figure out that West could not hold the ♠ K. Or, if you had needed to know, he could also not have had the ♦ A.